

SSC Maharashtra Board — Geography (Paper II)

March 2026 — Model Solutions

Time: 2 Hours

Max. Marks: 40

Q.1 Choose the correct alternative and complete the sentences:
[4 Marks]

(1) The cheapest mode of transport is

- (i) Roadways (ii) Waterways (iii) Airways (iv) Railways

Ans: (ii) Waterways

(2) The sunrays are perpendicular upto the in India.

- (i) Equator (ii) Tropic of Capricorn (iii) Tropic of Cancer (iv) Longitude

Ans: (iii) Tropic of Cancer

(3) In Brazil, a large amount of oxygen is released because of forest.

- (i) Deciduous (ii) Thorny (iii) Evergreen rain (iv) Himalayan

Ans: (iii) Evergreen rain

(4) India's per capita income is less than Brazil due to

- (i) Low national income (ii) Massive population (iii) Big family size (iv) Low foodgrain production

Ans: (ii) Massive population

Q.2 Identify the odd factor out:

[4 Marks]

(1) States in Brazil:

- (i) Sao Paulo (ii) Parana (iii) Bahia (iv) Uruguay

Ans: (iv) Uruguay

(2) Plateau region:

- (i) Maharashtra (ii) Pantanal (iii) Karnataka (iv) Telangana

Ans: (ii) Pantanal

(3) Heavy rainfall places in India:

- (i) Mawsynram (ii) Cherrapunji (iii) Jaisalmer (iv) Mahabaleshwar

Ans: (iii) Jaisalmer

(4) Major trading partners of Brazil:

- (i) China (ii) Germany (iii) USA (iv) Canada

Ans: (i) China

Q.3 State whether the sentences are right or wrong (any *four*):
[4 Marks]

(1) Naldurg is a hill fort.

Ans: Wrong.

(2) Brazil has the largest number of vegetation species in the world.

Ans: Right.

(3) Goa is not the most urbanised State.

Ans: Wrong.

(4) Fishing is concentrated in the South-Eastern coast of Brazil.

Ans: Right.

(5) Tourism is an invisible trade.

Ans: Right.

Q.4 (A) Mark the following in the outline map of Brazil and give index (any *four*): [4 Marks]

1. Coal producing regions
2. Rio de Janeiro
3. Thorny shrubs in Brazil
4. Equator
5. River Paraguay
6. States with lowest urban population

Ans:

(The student should mark the following on the outline map of Brazil and prepare an index.)

Sr. No.	Item	Location on Map
1	Coal producing regions	Southern Brazil (Rio Grande do Sul, Santa Catarina)
2	Rio de Janeiro	South-Eastern coast of Brazil
3	Thorny shrubs in Brazil	North-Eastern interior of Brazil (Caatinga region)
4	Equator	Passes through the northern part of Brazil
5	River Paraguay	Flows through western Brazil (Mato Grosso do Sul)
6	States with lowest urban population	Northern states (Amazonas, Pará, Maranhão)

Note: Mark any four of the above on the outline map of Brazil supplied and write the index beside the map.

Q.4 (B) Observe the map of India and answer the following questions (any *four*): [4 Marks]



(1) Name the lake to the far North of India.

Ans: The lake to the far north of India is **Wular Lake**.

(2) Name the major west flowing rivers in Central India.

Ans: The major west flowing rivers in Central India are **River Narmada** and **River Tapi (Tapti)**.

(3) Where does the river Kaveri originate?

Ans: The River Kaveri originates from Brahmagiri.

(4) River Manas is the tributary of which river?

Ans: River Manas is a tributary of the **River Brahmaputra**.

(5) What does the map indicate?

Ans: The map indicates **the main rivers and lakes of India**.

Q.5 Give geographical reasons (any *two*):

[6 Marks]

(1) Snowfall doesn't always occur in Brazil.

Ans:

1. Brazil is a tropical country.
2. Since Brazil has vast latitudinal extent it experiences a great range of climatic changes.
3. Near the equator it is hot, while temperate type of climate is found near Tropic of Capricorn.
4. It generally snows in those areas lying in the temperate or polar regions or in the mountainous regions of very high altitude.
5. But most part of the Brazil country lies in the tropical zone which experiences a hot and humid climate.
6. Hence, snowfall doesn't always occur in Brazil.

(2) India's population density is high.

Ans:

1. India's population density is high because India has the second largest population in the world (over 140 crore) spread over a relatively limited geographical area of 32.87 lakh sq. km.
2. India has vast fertile plains (Indo-Gangetic Plains) with rich alluvial soil, adequate water supply, and favourable climate, which support dense settlements and agriculture.
3. Early development of agriculture and irrigation facilities attracted large settlements in river valleys.

4. Industrial growth and urbanisation have led to concentration of population in urban areas.
5. High birth rate, better medical facilities reducing death rate, and improved life expectancy have contributed to the rapid growth of population.
6. Therefore, due to favourable geographical conditions, fertile land, and rapid population growth, India's population density is high.

(3) Availability of water is a major factor affecting settlements.

Ans:

1. Water is one of the most basic necessities for human survival. People need water for drinking, cooking, bathing, agriculture, and industrial purposes.
2. Historically, all major civilizations and settlements developed near rivers, lakes, or other water bodies (e.g., Indus Valley Civilization along the Indus River, settlements along the Ganga).
3. In areas where water is abundantly available (river banks, lake shores, well-irrigated regions), dense and permanent settlements develop.
4. In contrast, arid and semi-arid regions with scarce water supply (e.g., Thar Desert, Sahara) have sparse settlements and nomadic lifestyles.
5. Water availability also determines the type of agriculture, which in turn determines the economic activities and population concentration.
6. Therefore, availability of water is a critical factor that directly affects the location, density, and type of human settlements.

(4) There is mixed economy in Brazil and India.

Ans:

1. A mixed economy is one in which both the public (government) sector and the private sector coexist and contribute to the economic development of the country.
2. In India, the government owns and operates key industries like railways, defence, and atomic energy, while the private sector is active in IT, manufacturing, agriculture, and services.
3. In Brazil, the government controls key sectors like petroleum (Petrobras) and electricity, while the private sector plays a major role in agriculture (coffee, sugarcane, soybean), manufacturing, and mining.
4. Both countries have adopted the mixed economy model to ensure equitable distribution of resources while promoting economic growth through private enterprise.

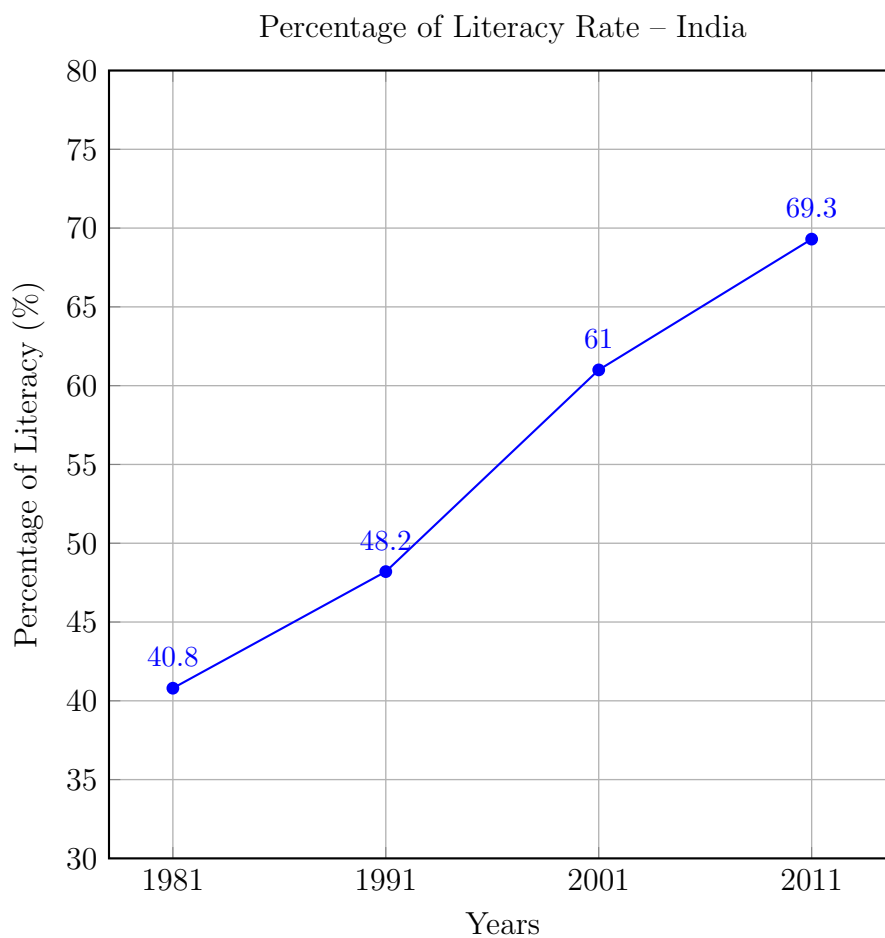
5. Neither country follows a purely capitalist nor a purely socialist model; both combine elements of both systems.
 6. Therefore, both Brazil and India have mixed economies where the government and private sector work together for economic development.
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Q.6 (A) With the help of given statistical data, prepare a simple line graph and answer the following questions: [6 Marks]

Percentage of literacy rate – India

Years	% of Literacy
1981	40.8
1991	48.2
2001	61.0
2011	69.3

Simple Line Graph:



Questions & Answers:

(1) What is the literacy rate in the year 2011?

Ans: The literacy rate in the year 2011 is **69.3%**.

(2) In the decade from 1991 to 2001, how much was an increase in literacy rate?

Ans: Literacy rate in 1991 = 48.2%

Literacy rate in 2001 = 61.0%

Increase in literacy rate = $61.0 - 48.2 = \mathbf{12.8\%}$

Increase in literacy rate from 1991 to 2001 = 12.8%

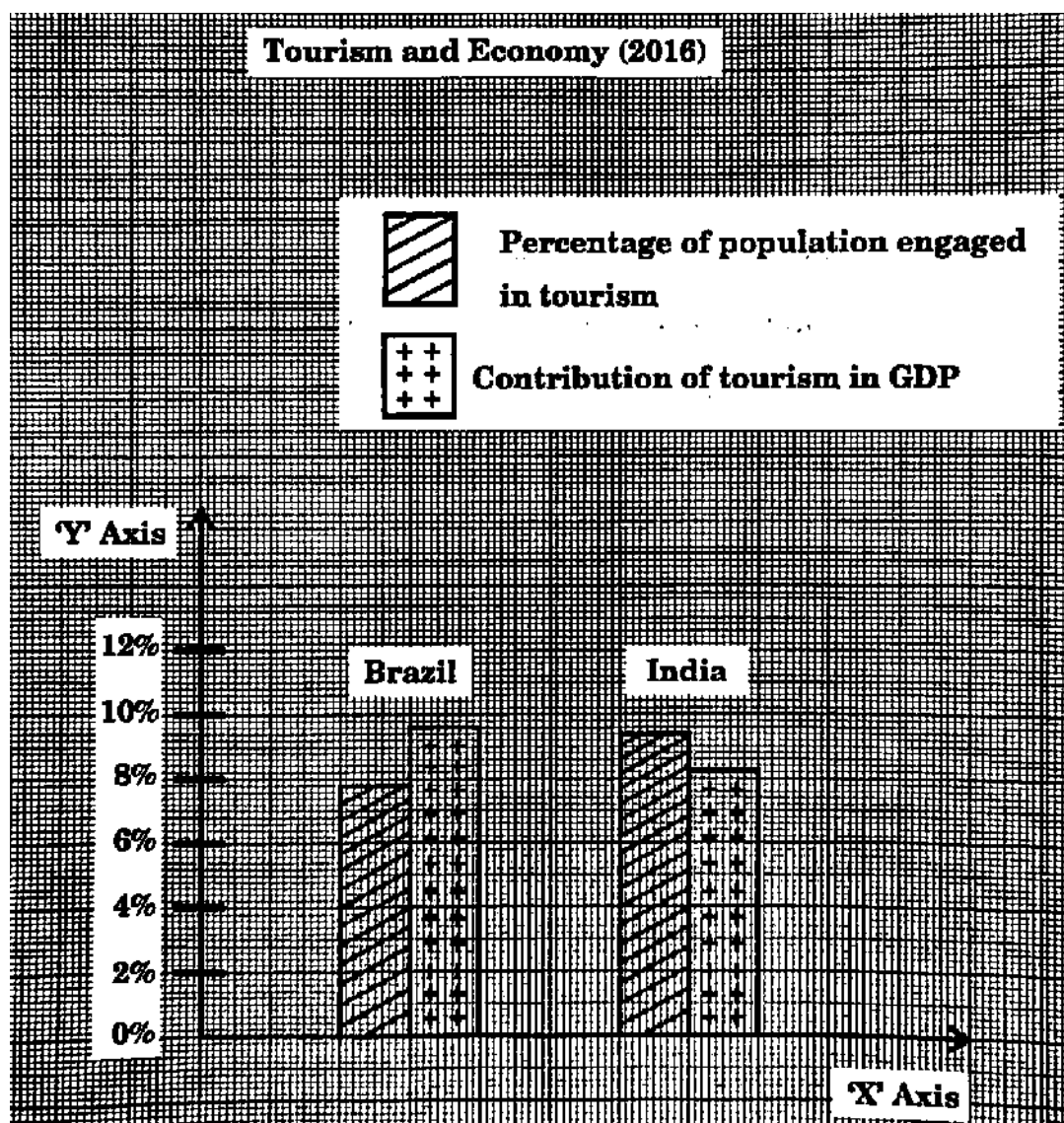
(3) In which year is the literacy rate upto 40.8%?

Ans: The literacy rate was 40.8% in the year **1981**.

Ans: 1981

Or

Q.6 (B) Read the graph and answer the following questions: [6 Marks]



Questions & Answers:

(1) What type of graph is shown here?

Ans: The graph shown here is a Double Bar Graph.

(2) What does the graph show?

Ans: The graph shows the Tourism and Economy data for the year 2016. It compares Brazil and India on two parameters — (i) Percentage of population engaged in tourism, and (ii) Contribution of tourism in GDP.

(3) Which country's tourism has a large share in the contribution towards GDP?

Ans: Brazil's tourism has a larger share in the contribution towards GDP.

(4) How much percentage of population in India is engaged in tourism?

Ans: According to the graph, approximately **9.4%** of the population in India is engaged in tourism.

(5) How much difference do you find in the population engaged in tourism in both the countries?

Ans: Population engaged in tourism in India = 9.4%

Population engaged in tourism in Brazil = 7.8%

Difference = $9.4\% - 7.8\% = 1.6\%$

Therefore, there is a difference of **1.6%** in the population engaged in tourism between India and Brazil.

(6) Which country has a large population engaged in tourism sector but contributes less in GDP?

Ans: India has a large population engaged in tourism sector but contributes less in GDP.

Q.7 Answer in detail (any *two*):

[8 Marks]

(1) What environmental issues are faced by Brazil and India?

Ans:

1. Brazil faces environmental degradation due to illegal smuggling of wild animals, deforestation, pollution, and slash-and-burn agriculture (Roka).
2. These activities lead to habitat destruction and loss of biodiversity..
3. Many endemic species in Brazil are on the verge of extinction due to these environmental problems.
4. India also faces environmental issues like poaching, pollution, and rapid deforestation.
5. The increasing deforestation in India leads to severe ecological imbalance.
6. Due to deforestation and habitat destruction, many wildlife species in India are on the verge of extinction.
7. Both Brazil and India are experiencing severe environmental damage due to human activities.

- Both countries need strict environmental policies and conservation efforts to protect their rich biodiversity.

(2) Describe the latitudinal and longitudinal extent of India and Brazil.

Ans:

Latitudinal and Longitudinal Extent of India:

- Latitudinal Extent:** India extends from **8°4'N** (Kanyakumari / Indira Point) to **37°6'N** (Indira Col, near Siachen Glacier in Jammu & Kashmir).
- The total latitudinal extent of India is approximately **29°2'** (about 30 degrees) from south to north.
- The **Tropic of Cancer (23°30'N)** passes through the middle of India, dividing it into the Tropical Zone (south) and the Sub-Tropical Zone (north).
- Longitudinal Extent:** India extends from **68°7'E** (Ghuar Mota in Gujarat) to **97°25'E** (Kibithu in Arunachal Pradesh).
- The total longitudinal extent of India is approximately **29°18'** (about 30 degrees) from west to east.
- The **Standard Meridian of India (82°30'E)** passes through Mirzapur (Uttar Pradesh) and determines the Indian Standard Time (IST).
- Due to the vast longitudinal extent, there is a time difference of about 2 hours between the eastern and western extremes of India.

Latitudinal and Longitudinal Extent of Brazil:

- Latitudinal Extent:** Brazil extends from **5°16'N** to **33°45'S**.
- The total latitudinal extent of Brazil is approximately **39 degrees** from north to south.
- Both the **Equator (0°)** and the **Tropic of Capricorn (23°30'S)** pass through Brazil.
- Most of Brazil lies in the Southern Hemisphere and in the Tropical Zone.
- Longitudinal Extent:** Brazil extends from **34°47'W** to **73°59'W**.
- The total longitudinal extent of Brazil is approximately **39 degrees** from east to west.
- Due to the vast longitudinal extent, Brazil has **four time zones**.

(3) Suggest your measures for conservation of Historical places.

Ans: The following measures can be suggested for the conservation of historical places:

1. **Legal Protection:** Historical monuments and heritage sites should be declared as “Protected Monuments” under the Ancient Monuments and Archaeological Sites and Remains Act (AMASR Act). This provides legal protection against encroachment, damage, and unauthorized construction.
2. **Regular Maintenance and Restoration:** Government agencies like the Archaeological Survey of India (ASI) and respective State Archaeology Departments should carry out regular maintenance, repair, and scientific restoration of historical structures.
3. **Creating Buffer Zones:** A buffer zone should be established around heritage sites where no construction or commercial activity is permitted. This helps in preserving the original environment and ambiance of the historical place.
4. **Public Awareness and Education:** People should be made aware of the historical and cultural significance of these places through school education, media campaigns, exhibitions, and heritage walks. This creates a sense of pride and responsibility among citizens.
5. **Controlled Tourism:** While tourism brings revenue, uncontrolled tourism can damage heritage sites. Entry should be regulated, carrying capacity should be defined, and anti-littering rules should be strictly enforced.
6. **Documentation and Digital Preservation:** All historical places should be thoroughly documented through photography, videography, 3D scanning, and digital archiving. This ensures that even if physical damage occurs, the record is preserved.
7. **Community Participation:** Local communities living near heritage sites should be involved in conservation efforts. They can serve as custodians of these sites and benefit economically through heritage tourism.
8. **Strict Penalties for Vandalism:** Strict laws and penalties should be enforced against those who damage, deface, or vandalize historical monuments. CCTV surveillance should be installed at important sites.
9. **International Cooperation:** India should seek help from international organizations like UNESCO for the conservation of important heritage sites. Many Indian sites are already UNESCO World Heritage Sites.
10. **Funding:** Adequate funds should be allocated by the government for conservation. Public-private partnerships and corporate CSR funds can also be utilized for heritage conservation.